Alexander Dovnar

Platform & DevOps Engineer · AWS, Kubernetes, Terraform · currently hands-on CTO

alex@alex-dovnar.in · linkedin.com/in/dovnaralex · alex-dovnar.in · Minsk, Belarus · Remote

SUMMARY

Platform and DevOps engineer with 15 years in infrastructure and 10 in AWS, Kubernetes and Terraform. Since February 2026 I have been CTO of Naviteq, a 50-engineer DevOps services company, and I still write infrastructure code every week: the company's internal platform of Terraform/OpenTofu modules, Helm charts and CI/CD workflows is my own work. Before that I led a team of 10 DevOps engineers, then the company's ~30-engineer DevOps practice, staying tech lead on the largest projects such as observability for ~20,000 gateways. Kubestronaut, co-author of "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025).

SKILLS

Cloud: AWS (expert), Azure, GCP, Oracle Cloud, Yandex Cloud, VK Cloud

IaC & Automation: Terraform / OpenTofu, Terragrunt, Helm, Helmfile, Ansible, Packer, Vault

Containers & Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD

CI/CD: GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Travis CI

Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, VictoriaMetrics, OpenSearch, OpenTelemetry

Security & FinOps: IAM hardening, secrets management, SBOM / supply-chain controls, cost optimization

AI Engineering: AI-assisted development with coding agents (Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot); building & integrating MCP servers; agentic workflow design & LLM-driven automation

Scripting: Python, Bash

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer — Naviteq Ltd

Feb 2026 – Present

- Design and build the company's internal infrastructure platform hands-on: reusable Terraform/OpenTofu modules for AWS and OCI, hardened Helm charts, GitHub Actions workflows and GitOps with Argo CD.
- Technical lead for AWS-to-OCI migrations: architecture, cost model and migration plan; an OCI assessment for an ad-tech client projected a 55% cut in non-production spend.
- Write high-level designs and estimations for cloud migrations and platform builds on AWS and Oracle Cloud (OCI).
- Set engineering standards across the company: architecture and code review, reference architectures and default tooling choices.
- Scope: technology lead of a 50-engineer DevOps services company; the Head of DevOps and 7 team leads report through me.

Head of DevOps — Naviteq Ltd

Apr 2024 – Jan 2026

- Ran the DevOps practice of ~30 engineers through team leads: staffing across client projects, hiring, performance and career growth.
- Owned engineering standards and architecture review across client projects; stayed hands-on as tech lead on the largest engagements.
- Designed the observability migration from Prometheus to VictoriaMetrics for a global cybersecurity vendor's SASE platform: ~20,000 gateways across ~60 production regions.
- Started and ran the internal tech-talk program (23 sessions).

DevOps Team Lead — Naviteq Ltd

Dec 2021 – Mar 2024

- One of the company's first engineers. Led a team of 10 DevOps engineers: hiring, onboarding, 1:1s, performance reviews and day-to-day technical direction.
- Together with the Head of DevOps, replaced a multi-day take-home assignment with a one-hour live technical interview.
- Tech lead on the company's key client projects; delivered 10+ projects end-to-end, from architecture design to production.
- Built a cloud-agnostic Kubernetes platform from scratch for a security startup.
- Moved EKS clusters from Cluster Autoscaler to Karpenter, raising node utilization from ~70% to 90%+.
- Architected highly available, secure AWS infrastructure with cost optimization (saved up to 40%); standardized reusable Terraform/Terragrunt templates and CI/CD pipelines across teams.

Senior DevOps Engineer — OneSoil

Aug 2021 – May 2022 (consulting)

- Designed a multi-account AWS architecture and built a Kubernetes platform with Prometheus/Grafana observability.
- Reduced cloud costs by ~30% with no loss of performance.

Lead System Engineer — EPAM Systems

Apr 2016 – Aug 2021

- Grew from junior to lead engineer over five years.
- Designed AWS infrastructure and automated it with Terraform and Ansible; built CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins.
- Led the team as tech lead: planned work, assigned tasks, and reviewed solutions.
- Migrated enterprise systems to AWS and Azure on international fintech and retail projects.

Senior Network Engineer — RUE Beltelecom

Mar 2011 – Apr 2016

- Maintained the backbone network and corporate clients (VPN, Ethernet, SHDSL); automated network equipment maintenance with custom scripts.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Kubestronaut (CNCF, 2025), all five certifications active: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Security Specialist (CKS, 2025–2027), Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD), KCNA, KCSA
- Earlier: AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (2023–2026), AWS Certified Security – Specialty (2022–2025), HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate, Cisco CCNA

COMMUNITY & PUBLIC ACTIVITY

- Co-author, "Cracking the Kubernetes Interview" (Packt, 2025; with Viktor Vedmich and Viktoria Semaan)
- Speaker: DevOpsDays Kazakhstan 2024, AWS Community Day Almaty 2025, DKT Conf 2026 (co-organizer)
- DevOps Kitchen Talks — co-host (2020–present); 100+ episodes, 300k+ views
- AWS Community Builder (2021–present); Terragrunt Ambassador (2025–present)
- Slurm.io — author & trainer for DevOps/SRE courses (CI/CD, Kubernetes, Terraform)

LANGUAGES

- English (fluent), Russian (native)

EDUCATION

- Engineer's degree, Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics (BSUIR), 2015